are so familiar to his colleagues.'[83] On 14 March Curzon used the House of Lords as the stage to defend himself against Montagu who had:

vilified the colleague whose advice in relation to India, Foreign and Frontier affairs he has not seized [sic – ceased?] both to solicit and to receive in unstinted measure in most weeks of recent years and endeavoured to sift some portion of the responsibility for his lamentable indiscretion on to my shoulders.

Curzon was being truthful when he claimed that Montagu had frequently turned to him for advice regarding India and Afghanistan; Montagu's communications with Chelmsford and Reading often mentioned Curzon's opinion on matters. One contemporary even believed that the foreign secretary 'terrorised' the secretary of state.[84] And yet, despite his apparent irritation with Curzon's constant 'hectoring', Montagu generally seemed ready to listen to the ex-viceroy. As time progressed, he even appeared to value Curzon's judgements more than that of Chelmsford or Reading – his acquiescence to the 1919 Anglo-Persian Agreement despite the protests of the Indian government is one such example. In fact, Montagu was apt to believe the views of numerous other sources both in India and in Britain over that given by the Indian government itself, something Chelmsford found particularly irritating. Indeed, generally speaking the India Office underrated the Indian government.[85] Montagu might lament the fact that the prime minister had no confidence in him, but he in turn appeared to lack confidence in his viceroys. Given the constitutional position and physical distance of the Indian government to the Home government, Delhi needed an ally in London if it was to make sure its views were listened to. Unfortunately, Montagu failed to be that ally.

Curzon's reaction to the publication of Reading's telegram is also very telling and is clear from the letter he wrote to Montagu the following day: